He proceeded to give out five pillars on which Bharat can achieve self-reliance: first, an economy that brings a quantum jump rather than incremental change. Second, infrastructure which is the identity of modern India. Third, a system which is based on superior technology-driven solutions. Fourth, our vibrant demography which can become the source of energy and lastly, demand. The strength of our demand can drive the cycle of demand and supply chains within our economy, harnessing its full potential. In order to increase demand in the country and to meet this demand, every stakeholder in our supply chain needs to be empowered and our supply chains strengthened by our labour force.

In line with the prime minister’s speech, the Union finance minister announced a new liquidity-driven, atmanirbhar relief package worth ₹20 lakh crore—amounting to 10 per cent of India’s GDP—to be released over five tranches in the next consecutive days. Keeping in mind the reverse migration which had already started to take place, enterprises which would soon start functioning at normal levels were bound to face a human resource crunch. The fallout of this would pan out as a breakdown of domestic supply chains. In order to attain high growth with moderate inflation, it became imperative to get the supply chain right. With a push in agriculture, coupled with good rainfall, ensured that the workers migrating to villages would most likely occupy themselves in jobs within the agricultural sector. Allotments to the National Rural Employment Guarantee programme were sharply increased so that rural infrastructure could be augmented quickly to support this growing workforce and economic activity. Several measures were announced as part of the package to provide relief to MSMEs, like collateral-free automatic loans as against 100 per cent government guarantee, equity infusion through funds and relaxations in employee provident fund contributions. The package included a special liquidity scheme for Non-banking Financial Institutions (NBFCs), Housing Finance Companies and Mutual Fund Investments, wherein securities issued by them would be fully guaranteed by the government. This also included a partial credit guarantee scheme for NBFCs wherein 20 per cent loss would be borne by the government. In tranche two of the packages, announced on 14 May, the focus was mostly on the farmers and middle-